How to use it

Ask questions and read the results; add policies, groups and models.

For: Staff and administrators

One chapter of the handbook. The full handbook, with every chapter, is handbook.pdf in the same folder.

For staff

Ask a question

Open the Policy Impact Assistant and type your question in your own words. Name two things:

1. **The group of policies to check**, such as Safety or HR
2. **The policy that changed**, either by its ID or name, or by attaching the new version

Examples:

> Which Safety policies are affected by the change to POL-007?
>
> Here's the new lockout policy. What in Safety needs updating? *(attach the file)*
>
> Check the HR group against the latest version of the leave policy.

If something is unclear, the assistant asks you one short question. A check usually takes one to a few minutes. Your chat waits for the answer (up to 10 minutes). If a check takes longer, the assistant tells you it is still running; ask again in a few minutes and it fetches the result.

Attaching a file: use `.docx`, `.pdf`, `.md` or `.txt`. The sections must be numbered (1, 2.1, 4.3...), because the system compares the policy section by section.

Without a file, the assistant compares the two newest stored versions of the policy. If only one version is stored, it asks you to attach the new one.

Read the answer

> **2 of the 5 Safety policies need updating because of the change to POL-007 (Lockout/Tagout).**

Then you'll see:

- **What changed** in the head policy, section by section
- **A table** of the sections that need updating, and why
- **"Might be affected"** policies. A person must check these: the system wasn't sure.
- How many were checked and are **not affected**
- **A link to the Excel file** with all the detail

If the assistant asks you to decide

Some installations pause a check when it has "maybe" sections, so a person settles them before the final answer. The assistant then lists the sections and shows a line to copy, like this:

> decide 3f9a1c2e SAF-150 3.1 , SAF-151 2.4

Type it as your **whole message**, starting with the word `decide`, and replace each `<yes|no>` with your own answer: `yes` if the section is affected, `no` if it is not. Add one entry for every section on the list. To answer every section the same way, type `decide 3f9a1c2e all no` (or `all yes`). The assistant cannot decide for you. When your decision is recorded, the check finishes and the assistant shows the final answer. Sections you leave out stay "Maybe", and the check ends; you can't decide it again afterwards. If you are told nothing was recorded, copy the line from the assistant again. The check number is only for this. Don't paste it where people outside the team can read it.

Use the Excel file

Sheet	What's on it
Summary	The question, the answer and the counts
Impacted	One row per affected section. **Red = needs updating. Yellow = a person must decide.** Each row shows the old and new wording, what the section says now, why it's affected, quotes as evidence, and a suggested edit
Head policy changes	Every changed section, old wording beside new
Checked, not impacted	Every other policy in the group, and why it was ruled out
Method	Which models and settings were used (for audits)
Charts	A bar chart of affected sections by policy
Change matrix	Which change in the head policy affects which policy

Fill in **Review decision** (Agree, Disagree, Not sure) and **Reviewer** as you go. The file is yours to keep and share inside the organisation.

The download link stops working after 72 hours. Ask the assistant again for a new one.

Get a report, chart or comparison

Just ask, in your own words, after a check or on its own:

Say something like	You get
"Can I have that as a PDF?" / "...as a Word report?"	A report of the last check: the answer, charts, the table of affected sections, and the old and new wording with changes marked
"Show me a chart of that"	Charts in the chat: affected sections by policy, which change affects which policy, kinds of impact
"Compare POL-007 version 3 with version 4"	A side-by-side comparison, section by section. Removed words are red and crossed out; new words are blue and underlined

Say something like	You get
"Compare this file with POL-007" (with a file attached)	The same comparison, against your file
"Compare SAF-112 and SAF-130 in Excel"	One row per section, in a workbook
"Make a one-page Word summary of this for the safety committee"	A document the assistant writes from what's in the chat. It says so at the top: check it before relying on it

Files can be Word (.docx), PDF, or Excel (.xlsx). Links last 72 hours; one-off documents are kept for 30 days, and reports of a check can always be made again.

What the system can and can't do

- It **finds and explains.** People still decide and approve every policy change.
- **"Maybe" never means "fine".** Always check these.
- It only knows the policies that have been loaded. If one seems missing, tell the system owner.
- It can be wrong in both directions. If it flags something that isn't affected, or misses something that is, tell the system owner. Mistakes are how it gets better.

Known limits

- **Scanned PDFs** (pictures of pages) can't be read yet. Use the Word or text version.
- **Word's automatic numbering** isn't stored as text, so a Word file whose numbers are automatic may appear to have no sections. Save it with the numbers typed in, or as PDF.
- **Policies outside the group** you named are not checked. Ask about each group separately.

For admins

Add or update policies

Put the files in `POLICY_SOURCE_DIR` and run:

```
docker compose run --rm policy-api python -m app.ingest /policies
```

Ingest is safe to repeat. A file whose header has the same `version` replaces that version; a higher `version`, or no version, adds a new one. Earlier versions are kept, so "compare the two newest versions" works without uploading anything.

Add a group, or move a policy between groups

Edit `subsets:` in the policy's header, then ingest that file again. A policy can be in several groups. A policy's groups are replaced each time it's ingested.

Turn on the second-opinion model (Inkling-Small)

Start it with `docker compose --profile escalate up -d escalate`, set `ESCALATE_URL=http://escalate:8000/v1` in `.env`, then run `docker compose up -d policy-api`. "Unsure" pairs then go to Inkling-Small. The **Checked by larger model** column in Excel shows which.

Find more references when ingesting

`--llm-refs` asks the `extract` model to find references that the ID pattern misses, such as "the lockout policy". Start the model first (`--profile extract`) and set `EXTRACT_URL` .

Change how wide the search is

In `.env` :

- `SEMANTIC_K` (default 30): how many similar clauses to consider for each change
- `RERANK_KEEP` (default 20): how many of those to judge

Raise them if evaluation shows misses on policies that don't cite the head policy. Lower them if runs are too slow. Clauses that cite the head policy, or use a changed term, are always judged regardless of these settings.

Look up what happened in a run

Every decision is in the `judgements` table:

```
docker compose exec db psql -U policy -c \
  "SELECT candidate_policy, candidate_number, stage, model, result->>'impacted', result->>'why'
   FROM judgements WHERE run_id = '<run id from the Excel Summary sheet>' ORDER BY
candidate_policy"
```